

Europe Trip Guide

7 Airbnb Bookings — Detailed Reference

Cities covered: Rome (×2) · Lucerne · Bern · Lauterach · Como · Alkmaar

Listings · Travel times · Cancellation rules · Red flags · Practical tips

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1. Detailed Listings

Each listing below includes location, setup, ratings, check-in details, kitchen status, pros, cons, red flags, and final score.

1■■■ Rome — Villa Fiorelli (Giusy)

Area	San Giovanni / Villa Fiorelli
Setup	70 sqm · 3 guests · 1 bed + sofa bed
Rating	★ 4.89 (38 reviews)
To Roma Termini	~15 min by metro (Line A)
Check-in	Self · Smartlock · After 3 PM
Checkout	Before 10 AM
Host	Giusy · Superhost · 9 months · 1h reply
Kitchen	Kitchenette + oven
AC / Washer	✓ AC · ✓ Washer
Parking / Pets	✗ Parking · ✓ Pets allowed

Pros

- Spotless, Giusy is a very thoughtful host
- Full kitchenette: fridge, oven, dishwasher, microwave, kettle, espresso
- AC, washer, pet-friendly, legally registered
- Bright apartment, mentioned thoughtful touches (decorations, birthday cake)

Cons

- Heavy street noise — sirens, cars (mentioned in 5 reviews)
- Low floor; building entrance hard to find first time
- No smoke alarm; 10 AM checkout is early

Red flags

- Bring earplugs — street noise is the #1 complaint
- Heating cuts at midnight (winter only — not relevant for June)

Rating: 8.0 / 10

2■■ Rome — Prati / Vatican (Elia)

Area	Prati (elegant, near Vatican)
Setup	80 sqm · 4 guests · 1 bed + sofa bed · 2nd floor + lift
Rating	★ 4.88 (57 reviews)
To Roma Termini	~25 min by metro (Lepanto → Termini, Line A)
Check-in	Self · Lockbox · 3–7 PM ONLY
Checkout	Before 10 AM
Host	Elia · Superhost · 2 years · 1h reply
Kitchen	Full separate kitchen + induction
AC / Washer	✓ AC (portable) · ✓ Washer + dryer
Parking / Pets	Free street parking · ✓ Pets allowed

Pros

- 10-min walk to Vatican — best Rome location
- Elevator + dryer + dedicated workspace
- Pet-friendly, dining table for 6, espresso + moka pot

Cons

- **Check-in only 3–7 PM** — extra fee charged for late arrival
- Bar noise downstairs at night (consistent across reviews)
- No smoke or CO alarm
- Only portable AC (less powerful than wall units)

Red flags

- Late check-in fee confirmed by reviewer Tolunay
- Address hard to find first time

Rating: 8.2 / 10

3■■ Lucerne — Eric

Area	Central Lucerne
Rating	★ 5.0 (only 6 reviews — small sample)
To Lucerne Bahnhof	~10 min walk (likely)
Check-in	Likely host-meet (Eric is talkative)
Host	Eric / Erick — friendly, communicative
Kitchen	✓ Full kitchen (CONFIRMED)
Kitchen details	Fridge, electric stove, oven, baking sheet, pots/pans, oil/salt/pepper, dining table, coffee
Bathroom	Bathtub, hair dryer, hot water
Laundry	Washer, bed linens, iron, wardrobe

Pros

- Perfect 5.0 rating; near lake; clean; welcoming host
- **Best-equipped kitchen of all 7** — oven + baking sheet + cooking basics confirmed

Cons

- Very few reviews (6) — limited data, provisional rating
- Switzerland is expensive overall

Red flags

- Verify check-in style and exact distance to Bahnhof before arrival

Rating: 7.5 / 10 (provisional — too few reviews)

4■■ Bern — Bümpliz (Huber) ■■

Area	Bümpliz (Bern suburb, NOT central)
Setup	Small · BASEMENT · 4 guests max · No door between rooms
Rating	★ 4.67 (600 reviews) — bottom 10% on Airbnb
To Bern Hauptbahnhof	5 min walk + 9 min train = ~15 min total
To Old Town	~25 min total
Check-in	After 3 PM · stairs required
Checkout	Before 11 AM (later than usual)
Host	Huber · 9 years · NOT Superhost
Kitchen	✓ Full + renovated · automatic coffee machine
AC / Washer	✗ AC · ✗ Washer
Parking / Transit	✓ Free 1 spot · ✓ Free Bern transit pass provided

Major red flags

- Confirmed BASEMENT — humidity, mold smell, dank air (15+ older reviews)
- Tiny bathroom; no privacy (no door between bedroom and living)
- Past reports: cockroach, broken appliances, blunt knives
- Host responds defensively to bad reviews publicly
- Mattress/pillows quality issues (3 recent confirmations)

Pros (recent reviews are better)

- Free Bern transit pass = saves ~CHF 10/day per person
- Possible free upgrade to attic apartment (mentioned 3× recent)
- Train station 5–10 min walk; free parking; helpful family
- Recent split (Sep 2025–Apr 2026): 13× 5★, 7× 4★, 2× 3★

Still hold true

- Bümpliz is suburb, not tourist area
- No bathroom power outlet — bring travel hair dryer
- No insect screen — mosquito risk in June

Rating: 6.5 / 10 (revised up from 4.0 based on recent reviews)

Action items before arrival:

- Ask Huber about attic upgrade availability
- Confirm transit tickets for your dates
- Ask about fan/AC for June
- Plan as 1-night stopover only — not for 2+ night Bern exploration

5■■ Lauterach (Austria) — Barnabas

Area	Lauterach (between Bregenz & Dornbirn, near Lake Constance)
Setup	4 guests · 1 bed + sofa bed · separate toilet/bath
Rating	★ 4.93 (15 reviews — mostly 2026)
To Lauterach Bahnhof	~5 min walk; Bregenz reachable in 10 min
Check-in	Self · Lockbox · After 2 PM (early!)
Checkout	Before 11 AM (later than usual)
Host	Barnabas · Superhost · 3 months hosting · 1h reply
Kitchen	✓ Full kitchen + extras (coffee pods, dishwasher tabs, detergent)
AC / Washer	✗ AC · ✓ Washer
Parking / Pets	✓ Garage + free spot + EV charging (22 kW) · ✓ Pets allowed

Pros

- Brand new, modern, tastefully furnished
- **Garage + free parking + EV charging**
- Bus stop in front (Bregenz/Dornbirn easy)
- Barnabas thoughtful — laundry/dishwasher tabs included
- Pet-friendly, separate toilet/bath

Cons

- Very new host (3 months) — limited track record
- No smoke/CO alarm reported
- Lauterach is small town (not tourist hub)

Rating: 9.0 / 10 — best value pick for the region

Action item: Message Barnabas about smoke alarm before arrival.

6■■■ Como — Terra Apartment (Giovanni) ■■

Area	Como historic center
Setup	3 guests · 1 bed + sofa bed · ground floor with garden
Rating	★ 4.94 (245 reviews) — Top 5% on Airbnb
To Como S. Giovanni	15-min walk
To Lake Como	5-min walk
Check-in	Self · Smartlock · After 3 PM
Checkout	Before 10 AM
Host	Giovanni · Superhost · 2 years · 97% reply rate
Kitchen	✓ Full + induction · fully equipped
AC / Washer	✓ AC · ✗ Washer (weekly cleaning + linen included)
Parking / Pets	Paid, available on request · ✓ Pets allowed

Pros

- **Top 5% globally**
- 5-min walk to lake; weekly cleaning + linen change included
- AC + heating; free luggage storage before/after check-in
- Brand new, historic building with courtyard

Cons

- Ground floor (no view)
- Bedroom has no door (open to living area)
- Minor past complaints — once-broken shower, lamp dispute

Rating: 9.2 / 10 — best of the lot

7■■■ Alkmaar — Red City Apartment (Joris) ■■■

Area	Alkmaar center (Netherlands)
Setup	Simple, small · 3 guests · 1 bed + sofa bed
Rating	★ 4.46 (41 reviews) — weakest of the 7
To Alkmaar Station	~10 min walk
To Amsterdam Centraal	30–35 min direct train (every 15 min)
Check-in	After 3 PM
Checkout	TBC (not stated in listing)
Host	Joris (+ co-host Bram) · Not Superhost · 1h reply
Kitchen	Basic kitchen (some utensils missing per reviews)
AC / Washer	✗ AC · ✓ Washer + dryer
Parking / Pets	Paid (~€25/day) · ✗ No pets
Safety	Exterior security cameras, smoke alarm, CO alarm

Pros

- Great location (4.9 location score)
- Near cheese market, train station
- Free washer + dryer; walkable old town

Cons

- Cheap furnishings, slightly worn
- Single-glazed windows — cold in winter, noisy in summer
- Sofa bed uncomfortable; missing utensils (no strainer, only 3 chairs)
- No AC (June can hit 25–28°C)

Red flags

- Lowest rating in the batch
- For Saturday nights: last train Amsterdam→Alkmaar is ~1 AM

Rating: 7.0 / 10 — works for short stays only

2. Master Comparison Table

#	City / Host	Rating	Check-in	Kitchen	AC	Score
1	Rome SG Giusy	4.89	3 PM smartlock	Kitchenette + oven	✓	8.0
2	Rome Prati Elia	4.88	3-7 PM lockbox	Full + induction	✓	8.2
3	Lucerne Eric	5.0 (6 rev.)	TBC	Full + oven + basics	?	7.5
4	Bern Huber ■	4.67 (600 rev.)	3 PM	Full renovated	✗	6.5
5	Lauterach Barnabas	4.93	2 PM lockbox	Full + extras	✗	9.0
6	Como Giovanni ■	4.94	3 PM smartlock	Full + induction	✓	9.2
7	Alkmaar Joris ■	4.46	3 PM	Basic	✗	7.0

Can you cook chicken & rice in all 7?

YES — all 7 apartments have working kitchens. Every one has stove, fridge, pot/pan, plates. You can cook chicken, rice, eggs, pasta, bread anywhere.

Best kitchens (most equipped)

- **Lucerne (Eric)** — confirmed: oven + baking sheet + cooking basics
- **Lauterach (Barnabas)** — new, with coffee pods + detergent
- **Bern (Huber)** — renovated, automatic coffee machine
- **Como (Giovanni)** — fully equipped, induction

3. Travel Times & Distances

Distance from each apartment to its main railway station

Apartment	Station	Travel time
1. Rome SG (Giusy)	Roma Termini	15 min metro (Line A)
2. Rome Prati (Elia)	Roma Termini	25 min metro (Lepanto → Termini)
3. Lucerne (Eric)	Lucerne Bahnhof	~10 min walk
4. Bern (Huber)	Bern Hauptbahnhof	5–10 min walk + 9 min train = 15 min
5. Lauterach (Barnabas)	Lauterach Bahnhof	5 min walk
6. Como (Giovanni)	Como S. Giovanni	15 min walk
7. Alkmaar (Joris)	Alkmaar Station	10 min walk

Cross-trip route times

Route	Details
Interlaken → Bern Hbf	52 min direct IC train · every 30 min · ~CHF 30
Alkmaar → Amsterdam Centraal	30–35 min · every 15 min · ~€8–10

Last-train warnings (Saturday night from Amsterdam)

- Alkmaar — last train ~1:00 AM (limited)
- Haarlem — last train ~2:00 AM (frequent) — best for nightlife
- Zaandam — last train ~1:30 AM

4. Red Flags to Avoid (For Future Bookings)

Major red flags

Red flag	Why it matters
"Basement" in description	Humidity, mold, dampness (Huber problem)
"Studio" for 3+ guests	Too cramped for actual living
"Houseboat"	Cute but small + can smell of canal in summer
"Property management" host bio	Auto-managed = no real care
Single-glaze windows	Cold in winter, noisy in summer (Alkmaar)
"Long-term only" in title	Can't book short stays
No reviews + new host	Unproven; risky
"Stairs only" / 4+ floor walk-up	Hard with luggage in Europe
"automatebnb" or similar in bio	Auto-managed = poor service
Strict 3–7 PM check-in window	Inflexible for late arrivals
Below 4.5 rating	Quality issues likely
Below 30 reviews	Unproven quality

Must-have green flags

Green flag	Why it matters
Rating 4.7 or higher	Reliable quality
30+ reviews	Proven track record
Superhost badge	Reliable host
Full kitchen (not kitchenette)	Real cooking possible
Smoke + CO alarms	Safety basics
Self check-in (smartlock/lockbox)	Flexibility on arrival

Bonus features worth looking for

- Free parking — saves €15–30/day
- Free transit pass (Switzerland especially) — saves €10/day per person
- Late checkout (11 AM+) — less rush
- Washer + dryer — for trips longer than 4 days
- Dishwasher — saves time
- Oven — for real cooking
- Coffee machine — morning saver
- Pet-friendly — flexibility if applicable

5. Cancellation Rules

Standard Airbnb policies (3 tiers)

Tier	Rules
Flexible	Free cancel up to 24h before check-in
Moderate	Free cancel up to 5 days before
Strict	50% refund up to 7 days before; nothing after

How to see the exact policy for your booking

- Open Airbnb → **Trips** → select your booking
- Look for “**Cancellation policy**”
- Will show: “*Free cancellation before [specific date]*”

Refund timing if you cancel before deadline

- **Full refund (100%)** to original payment method
- Airbnb processes within 24–48 hours
- Bank shows it in 5–15 business days total

If you cancel after deadline

- Partial or no refund
- First night usually non-refundable
- Cleaning fee always refunded
- Airbnb service fee always refunded

6. Practical Travel Tips

Power outlets

Country	Plug type
Italy	Type C, F, L (mostly C/F same as rest of Europe)
Switzerland	Type J — DIFFERENT from rest of Europe!
Austria	Type C, F (standard EU)
Netherlands	Type C, F (standard EU)

Bring a universal travel adapter — covers all of these.

Bathroom power for hair dryer

- Many older European bathrooms have no power outlets (Bern is one)
- Workaround: dry hair near bedroom outlet instead
- Or bring a travel-size hair dryer

Mosquitoes (June)

- June = mosquito season in some places
- Bern apartment has no insect screens — bring repellent

Packing checklist

- Universal travel adapter
- Earplugs (Rome 1 and Alkmaar especially)
- Travel hair dryer (Bern especially)
- Mosquito repellent
- Reusable shopping bag (EU charges for plastic)
- Small first-aid kit

7. Netherlands City Rankings

Tier S — Must-see

City	Why visit	Time needed
1. Amsterdam	Canals, museums, vibe, food, nightlife	2–3 days
2. Utrecht	Locals' Amsterdam — same canals, half the tourists	1 day

Tier A — Highly recommended

City	Why visit	Time needed
3. Haarlem	Mini Amsterdam, gorgeous, 15 min away	Half day
4. Delft	Fairytale town, blue pottery, Vermeer	Half day
5. Leiden	University town, beautiful canals	Half day
6. Rotterdam	Modern architecture, very different vibe	1 day
7. The Hague	Royal city, beach, political capital	1 day

Tier B — Worth it for theme

City	Best for
8. Zaanse Schans	Iconic windmills
9. Giethoorn	“Venice of the North”
10. Maastricht	South, feels Belgian/French
11. Alkmaar	Friday cheese market
12. Volendam / Marken	Fishing villages, traditional dress
13. Kinderdijk	UNESCO windmills

Cheaper alternatives near Amsterdam

Town	Train to A'dam	Why it's cheap
Zaandam	12 min	Modern, near windmills
Haarlem	15 min	Most charming, mini-Amsterdam
Hoofddorp	15 min	Near Schiphol airport
Almere	20 min	Cheapest but ugly
Diemen	10 min	Suburb, very close
Leiden	35 min	University town, less touristy

Is Netherlands worth 2 days?

Yes — barely. 2 days = bare minimum for Amsterdam highlights. Don't fly here just for 2 days, but as part of a longer European trip → absolutely worth it.

8. Final Recommendations & Checklists

Priority actions

■ *High priority*

- **Reconsider Bern (Huber)** — basement issues, host problems. Better to do Bern as day trip from Interlaken (52 min train each way).

■ *Medium priority*

- **Keep Alkmaar** — fine for 2 nights but bring earplugs. For Sat–Sun, plan to be back by 10:30 PM (last train).

■ *Low priority — message hosts*

- Verify Lucerne (Eric) check-in details before arrival
- Message Giusy (Rome 1) about June AC strength
- Message Elia (Rome 2) to confirm 3–7 PM check-in window
- Message Barnabas (Lauterach) about smoke alarm

Final ranking (best → worst)

Rank	Listing	Score	Why
■ 1	Como — Giovanni	9.2	Top 5%, 245 reviews, perfect location
■ 2	Lauterach — Barnabas	9.0	Brand new, garage, near station
■ 3	Rome Prati — Elia	8.2	Best Rome location
4	Rome SG — Giusy	8.0	Quieter Rome stay
5	Lucerne — Eric	7.5	Promising but few reviews
6	Alkmaar — Joris	7.0	Weak — short stays only
7	Bern — Huber	6.5	Stopover only, not exploring

Pre-trip checklist (for each booking)

- ■ Confirmation email with property address
- ■ Smartlock code / lockbox code (host sends 1–3 days before)
- ■ WiFi password
- ■ House manual PDF
- ■ Host's WhatsApp/phone (in case of issues)
- ■ Cancellation deadline noted in calendar
- ■ Earplugs (Rome 1, Alkmaar)
- ■ Universal travel adapter
- ■ Travel hair dryer (Bern)